

The “Deep Travel” Braid Essay

Genre Context:

- When **Braiding** an author weaves together at least two (but sometimes more) disparate moments of time and/or place in the same essay. The idea is that each braid serves to contextualize, deepen, and texturize the other/s simply by existing in a shared body of work—even if seemingly unrelated.
- For “**Deep Travel**” (a memoir & travel-writing hybrid genre) braids typically work to bridge moments on a specific journey with moments elsewhere--typically those at home (but can be other places, too).
- SAMPLE TEXT: To listen to an award-winning Deep Travel essay written on a past DAT trip, [listen to this podcast recording](#).

To Do:

· Weave together at least two (but maybe more) braids to create a cohesive, more fully developed draft of at least 1000 words. (No real minimum or maximum, but we’re looking for these to get deeper and more expansive than we’ve had time for in the workshops.) You want a whole draft of some kind!

- You can work with/revise/expand any combination of writing we’ve started so far and/or incorporate entirely new scenes/braids if you want. You’re welcome to keep going on something or to start from scratch for some or all!
- It would be great if at least one of your braids incorporates water in some way/s—a way you’ve explored already or in a new way (or both!). This is not required but something to think about!

Our Ongoing List of Craft Elements to Think About:

- **Hyper-Specific Details**
 - **Sensory Imagery** (Consider the 5 senses)
 - Capture the **Mundane!**
 - Find the quirky, surprising, random, palpable details that are intensely exact and seemingly insignificant. Show us the mundane details over the sacred, and we’ll feel it more!

- Find your **Proper Noun** opportunities! (People, places, things that are capitalized such as specific names of people, cities, schools, companies, stores.)
- **Conflict/Tension**: through mood or plot—is there some issue or problem or conflict present here? (Explicitly or implicitly)
- **Scene over Summary**: be sure we're in scenes (past and present) and not talking ABOUT memories. Step INSIDE a memory and let us live it with you as if we're living it in present time with/as you.
- **Dialogue**: explicitly hearing folks talk means we're in a scene and including what they said with quotes is always hyper-specific!
- **Translanguaging**: You can incorporate words, passages, concepts etc in any language/es that work. Any movement at all between languages is not only interesting, but it often lends to more accurate storytelling
- **Make yourself a Character Part 1**: We will aim to run a workshop on some of the more complicated facets of this, but—for now—think about elements of yourself an audience wouldn't know. Can you include at least 3-4 of these somehow?
 - Age
 - Hometown/Current residence
 - Appearance details
 - Occupation or field of study
 - Nationality/Ethnic/Racial background
 - Religion
 - Family details (birth order, role as a mother or brother or)
 - Hobbies/interests
 - Favorites/least favorite things